A Field Guide to Local First Software

by the inkling benchmark team

1. Introduction

Local first means your data lives on your device and works without a connection. Your library is a database and a folder of files, not a remote account.

2. The Capture Rule

Saving must be faster than deciding where something belongs. If a note takes three taps to make, people will not take notes.

3. The Retrieval Promise

Search is the primary organizing system. Tags and folders are optional furniture; the index is the floor plan.

4. Closing

Keep it quiet, keep it local, and let the index do the work. End of field guide.